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16 December 1985
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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CHAIN ASSEMBLY AND CROSS CHAIN, TIRE: FOR MILITARY VEHICLES

This specification is approved for use by US Army Tank-Automotive Command, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers tire chain assemblies and spare cross chains, utilizing swivel hook type cross chain connectors, for use on military tactical wheeled vehicle single truck tires (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. Tire chains described in this specification shall be classified as follows (see 6.2):

Type TS	- Chain assembly, single tire.
Type CC	- Cross chain.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Tank-Automotive Command, ATTN: AMSTA-GDS, Warren, MI 48397-5000, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document, or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 2540
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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. Unless otherwise specified, the following specifications, standards, and handbooks of the issue listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS
FEDERAL

NN-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
CCC-C-429	- Cloth, Cotton, Osnaburg.
PPP-B-585	- Boxes, Wood, Wireboard.
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-P-116	- Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-C-16173	- Corrosion Preventive Compound, Solvent Cutback, Cold-Application.
PPP-T-60	- Tape Packaging, Waterproof.

STANDARDS
MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-130	- Identification Marking of US Military Property.
MIL-STD-1186	- Cushioning, Anchoring, Bracing, Blocking, and Waterproofing; with Appropriate Test Methods.
MIL-STD-45662	- Calibration Systems Requirements.
MS500055	- Chain Assembly, Single Tire, Type TS.
MS500056	- Chain, Side and Inner (Dual and Single Tire).
MS500057	- Cross Chain, Dual and Single Tire.
MS500058	- Hook, Swivel: Tire Chain (Size "A").
MS500059	- Hook, Swivel: Tire Chain (Size "B").
MS500060	- Hook, Swivel: Tire Chain (Size "C").

(Copies of specifications, standards, handbooks, drawings, and publications required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following document(s) form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. The issues of the documents which are indicated as DoD adopted shall be the issue listed in the current DoDISS and the supplement thereto, if applicable.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM E3	- Metallographic Specimens Methods of Preparation.
ASTM E18	- Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials, Test Methods for.
ASTM E407	- Microetching Metals and Alloys.

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

(Industry association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish chain assemblies which shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4). First article inspection samples, properly marked with identifying information shall be representative of the unit to be furnished to the Government. All subsequent chain assemblies delivered to the Government shall conform to these samples in all of their pertinent physical and performance attributes.

3.2 Material. The materials used in all chains and attachments shall conform to the applicable military standard specified in 3.3 (see 4.6.1).

3.3 Design and construction. Tire chain assemblies shall conform to the applicable chain assembly drawing as follows (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

Type TS	- MS500055
Type CC	- MS500057

3.3.1 Components. Tire chain assemblies shall be made up of the following components, and suitable end fasteners, as specified on the applicable chain assembly drawing (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

Chain, side and inner	- MS500056
Chain, cross, Type CC	- MS500057
Hook, swivel	- MS500058, MS500059, or MS500060

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3.3.2 Side chains. Side chains shall have the wire size, inside length, and inside width in accordance with the applicable tire size as specified in the military standards. Side chains shall be straight-link welded and case hardened (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

3.3.3 Cross chains. Type CC chains shall have the wire size, inside length, and inside width in accordance with the applicable tire size as specified in the military standards. Type CC chains shall be twist-link, welded and case hardened (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

3.3.4 Connectors. Connectors for cross chains shall be of the swivel hook type fabricated and case hardened in accordance with MS500058, MS500059, or MS500060, as applicable. Swivel hook assemblies shall be capable of being installed and removed without the use of any tool(s) (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

3.3.5 Fasteners. Fasteners shall be compatible with the side chains in materials, processing, size, and construction (see MS500056) so as to have a useful life at least equal to that of the side chains. Fasteners for side chains shall be so constructed that they can be quickly and securely fastened to the ends of side chains and cannot be accidentally detached. They shall be readily opened and closed (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

3.3.5.1 Spacing of cross chains. The number of cross chains required per half-pair of Type TS chains shall be in accordance with the applicable military standard. In assembling the tire chains, the first cross chain shall be attached to that link of each side chain nearest the connector that will permit the end hook to lie in the proper plane when the assembled tire chain is applied to the tire. The remainder of the cross chains shall be attached to the side chains at equal intervals of four links each (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

3.4 Chain length. The actual length of side chains, and cross chains, shall be as specified on MS500056 or MS500057, as applicable (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

3.5 Physical properties.

3.5.1 Hardness. Hardness of the component parts, side and inner chains, cross chains, hook swivel (with or without the washer) (see 3.3.1) shall meet the specified Rockwell hardness HRC, or equivalent, as shown on the drawings (see 4.6.3).

3.5.2 Case depth. Total case depth of the component parts (see 3.3.1), shall conform to the limits specified. Case depth of the cross links shall be dependent upon the nominal wire size specified for the links (see 4.6.4).

3.6 Identification marking. Identification marking of the tire chain assembly shall be on the fasteners, in accordance with MIL-STD-130 (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

3.7 Finish. All chains and attachments shall have a smooth surface, be devoid of roughness and shall have a clean, scale-free finish (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

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3.8 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be such as to produce chain assemblies and chains free from burrs, scale, sharp edges and faulty welding (see 4.5.2 and 4.6.2).

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see 6.2), the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform or witness any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection equipment. Unless otherwise specified in the contract (see 6.2), the contractor is responsible for the provision and maintenance of all inspection equipment necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to contract requirements. Inspection equipment must be capable of repetitive measurements to an accuracy of 10 percent of the measurement tolerance. Calibration of inspection equipment shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-45662.

4.2 Classification of inspection:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspections (see 4.5).
   1. Examination (see 4.5.2).
   2. Tests (see 4.5.3).

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), all inspections shall be conducted under the following conditions.

a. Air temperature 23° $\pm$ 10° C.
b. Barometric pressure $\overline{725}^{-75}$ $\pm$ 50 mm Hg
c. Relative humidty 50 $\pm$ 30 percent.

4.4 First article inspection. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the Government shall select four chain assemblies produced under the production contract for first article inspection. First article samples shall be inspected as specified in table I. Approval of the first article sample by the Government shall not relieve the contractor of his obligation to supply chain assemblies that are fully representative of those inspected as a first article sample. Any changes or deviation of the production units from the first article sample shall be subject to the approval of the contracting officer.

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4.4.1 First article inspection failure. Test item deficiencies during, or as a result of, the first article test, shall be cause for rejection of the items until evidence has been provided by the contractor that corrective action has been taken to eliminate the deficiency. Any deficiency found during, or as a result of the first article test, shall be prima facie evidence that all items already produced prior to completion of the first article test are similarly deficient unless evidence satisfactory to the contracting officer is furnished by the contractor that they are not similarly deficient. Such deficiencies on all items shall be corrected by the contractor at no cost to the Government. The Government shall not final accept products until first article testing is completed to the satisfaction of the Government.

TABLE I. Classification of inspections.

Title	Requirement	Inspection	First article	Quality conformance	
				Examination	Tests
Materials	3.2	4.6.1	X		
Defects (see table II)	3.3 thru 3.4, 3.6 thru 3.8	4.6.2	X	X	
Hardness	3.5.1	4.6.3	X		X
Case depth	3.5.2	4.6.4	X		X

4.5 Quality conformance inspection.

4.5.1 Sampling.

4.5.1.1 Lot formation. An inspection lot shall consist of all the chain assemblies of one type and part number, from an identifiable production period, from one manufacturer, submitted at one time for acceptance.

4.5.1.2 Sampling for examination. Samples for quality conformance examination shall be selected in accordance with general inspection level II of MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1.3 Sampling for testing. Samples for quality conformance testing shall be selected in accordance with inspection level S-3 of MIL-STD-105.

4.5.2 Quality conformance examinations.

4.5.2.1 Acceptable quality level. Each sample selected in accordance with 4.5.1.2 shall be examined to determine conformance to the following acceptable quality levels (AQL) on the basis of percent defective.

Classification	AQL
Major	1.0
Minor	2.5

4.5.2.2 Classification of defects. For examination purposes, defects shall be classified as listed in table II.

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TABLE II. Classification of defects.

Category	Defect	Method of examination
Critical	None	
Major	AQL 1.0% Defective	
101	Dimensions affecting interchangeability not within tolerance (see 3.3 through 3.3.3, and 3.4).	SIE 1/
102	Improper weld on any cross chain link (see 3.3.3).	Visual
103	Improper finish on chains or attachments (see 3.7).	Visual
104	Improper construction of connectors (see 3.3.4).	Visual
105	Improper construction of fasteners and cross chains (see 3.3.5 and 3.3.5.1).	SIE 1/
106	Improper marking (see 3.6).	Visual
Minor	AQL 2.5% Defective	
201	Dimensions not affecting interchangeability not within tolerance (see 3.3 through 3.3.3, and 3.4).	SIE 1/
202	Poor workmanship affecting appearance (see 3.8).	Visual

1/ SIE = Standard Inspection Equipment.

4.5.3 Quality conformance tests. Samples selected in accordance with 4.5.1.3 shall be subjected to the control tests specified in table I.

4.5.3.1 Failure. Inspection failures in excess of specified AQL levels shall be cause for the Government to refuse acceptance of the production quantity represented, until action taken by the contractor to correct defects and prevent recurrence has been approved by the Government.

4.6 Methods of inspection.

4.6.1 Materials and construction. To determine conformance to 3.2 shall be determined by inspection of contractor records providing proof or certification that design, construction, processing, and materials conform to requirements. Applicable records shall include drawings, specifications, design data, receiving inspection records, processing and quality control standards, vendor catalogs and certifications, industry standards, test reports, and rating data.

4.6.2 Defects. Conformance to 3.3 through 3.4, 3.6, 3.7 and 3.8 shall be determined by examination for the defects listed in table II. Examination shall be visual, tactile, or by measurement with standard inspection equipment.

4.6.3 Hardness. To determine conformance to 3.5.1, the component parts referenced in 3.3.1 shall be tested for Rockwell hardness in accordance with the procedures outlined in ASTM E18.

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4.6.4 Case depth. To determine conformance to 3.5.2, total case depth shall be determined on properly ground and etched cross sections of component parts. Preparation of these parts, for proper evaluation, shall conform to ASTM E3. Choice of etchant and selection of time to reveal the total case depth, and case microstructure, if required, shall conform to ASTM E407. Measurement of total case depth shall be performed with an appropriate microscope equipped with a calibrated eyepiece.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation and packaging. Preservation and packaging of tire chain assemblies and cross chains shall be level A.

5.1.1 Cleaning. Chain assemblies and cross chains shall be cleaned in accordance with process C-1 of MIL-P-116.

5.1.2 Drying. Chain assemblies and cross chains shall be dried by the most applicable procedure specified in MIL-P-116.

5.1.3 Preservative application. Chain assemblies and cross chains shall be coated with preservative conforming to grade 1 of MIL-C-16173.

5.1.4 Unit package.

5.1.4.1 Type TS chain assemblies. When unit packaging is specified in table III chain assemblies shall be placed in a bag, fabricated from osnaburg cotton conforming to type I, class 1 or 2 of CCC-C-429.

5.1.4.2 Type CC cross chains. Cross chains shall be unit packaged in quantities as specified by the procuring activity, but not to exceed 20 pounds (see 6.2). Unit quantities shall be placed in a snug fitting box conforming to class weather resistant, grade W6c, style RSC of PPP-B-636. The box shall be closed by applying two strips of 2 inch tape conforming to PPP-T-60, type III, class I. One strip is added each on the top and bottom seams and extending 3 inches onto each end panel, or to the full distance of the depth when depth is less than 3 inches.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A.

5.2.1 Type TS chain assemblies. Tire chain assemblies shall be packed in the type of exterior container as specified in table III. Tire chain assemblies not listed in these tables shall be packed in boxes specified in 5.2.1.1 in which the net weights shall be confined to the limitations specified in table IV. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-585. When tested, the box shall meet the requirements specified for the interior packing tests of MIL-STD-1186.

5.2.1.1 Boxes. Wirebound boxes specified herein shall be for the maximum net weight designated in table IV, and constructed in accordance with 5.2.1.2.3.

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5.2.1.2 Construction. Boxes shall be constructed in accordance with the applicable details specified in 5.2.1.2.1, 5.2.1.2.2, 5.2.1.2.3, figures 1 through 4, and the general requirements specified for style 3 box of PPP-B-585. Wood used in construction of boxes shall be from the group II woods of PPP-B-585.

5.2.1.2.1 Type 1 box (see figures 1 and 2). Type I boxes shall be constructed as follows:

a. The mat size of the type I box shall be determined from figure 1. The box mat shall have a 1/4 inch overlap at each edge of the top and bottom sections.
b. Five binding wires shall be placed on the mat as shown in figure 1. The binding wire shall be 12 gage, galvanized finish and shall conform to the requirements specified for binding wire in PPP-B-585.
c. Cleats shall be 13/16 by 7/8 by 9 1/8 inches. The ends shall be mitered. The side section cleats (see figure 1) shall be notched 3/4 inch wide by 1/8 deep wherever the end assembly wire loops (see figure 2) are to pass through the side cleats.
d. The type 1 mat shall be assembled by placing 1 1/4 inch, 16 degree staples into cleats. Four staples shall be placed into the side section cleats and 5 staples shall be placed into the top and bottom section cleats. Staples, 7/16 inch, 18 degrees, shall be placed over the binding wires (see 5.2.1.2.1b). Arrangements of the stapling and mat assembly are shown in figure 1.
e. The end assembly for type 1 box shall be constructed as shown in figure 2. The ends shall be assembled by 2 inch spacing of 11/16 inch, 18 degree clinched staples placed into the liners and 7/16 inch, 20 degree clinched staples over the end wire (see figure 2). The end wire shall be 13 gage, galvanized wire and the loops of end wire shall extend 1 5/8 inches beyond the edge of the end face material.

5.2.1.2.2 Type 2, 3, and 4 (see figures 3 and 4). Type 2, 3, and 4 boxes shall be constructed as follows:

a. The mat size for type 2, 3, and 4 boxes shall be determined from figure 3. The box mat shall be fabricated from 3/8 inch face stock having a 3/8 inch overlap at each edge of the top and bottom.
b. The wire used on the box mat shall be 12-gage, galvanized finish and shall conform to the requirements specified for binding wire of PPP-B-585. The number of wires required for the applicable box mat is specified in table V.
c. Cleats shall be 1 1/8 by 1 1/8 inch by the applicable length specified in figure 3. The ends of the cleats shall be mitered. Notches 3/4 inches wide by 1/8 inch deep, shall be provided wherever the end assembly wire loops (see figure 4) are to pass through the side cleats.

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d. The assembly of the box mats for type 2, 3, and 4 shall be accomplished by placing 1 3/8 inch, 14 degree staples into the cleats. The number of staples required for each type box shall be as specified in table VI. The binding wires (see 5.2.1.2.2b) shall be secured to the box mat by 9/16 inch, 18 degree staples.
e. The end assembly for type 2, 3, and 4 boxes shall be constructed as shown in figure 4. The ends shall be assembled by 2 inch spacing of 13/16 inch, 18 degree clinched staples placed into the liners and 9/16 inch, 18 degree clinched staples placed over the end wires. The loops of the end wire shall extend 2 1/4 inches past the edges as shown in figure 4.

5.2.1.2.3 Assembling of boxes. Assembling of boxes shall be in accordance with the requirements specified for style 3 box of the appendix to PPP-B-585, except that boxes type 1, 2, 3 and 4 require no nailing or strapping in assembly.

5.2.2 Type CC cross chains. Unit packages shall be placed in a wirebound wood box conforming to class 3, style 2, or 3 of PPP-B-585; or nailed wood box conforming to class 2, style 2, 2 1/2 or 3 of NN-B-621. Gross weight shall not exceed 200 pounds. Box shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable box specification or appendix thereto. When tested the exterior container shall meet the requirements specified for the interior packing test of MIL-STD-1186.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, bags, unit packages, and exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.1 Bags. In addition to the requirements specified in MIL-STD-129, the bags shall be marked to indicate the type, size, and quantity of chains per bag as indicated in table III.

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TABLE III. Type TS, chain assembly, single tire MS500055(AT).

Tire size	Unit package		Type of exterior container required (see 5.2.1.2)
	Quantity of chains per bag (see 5.1.1.4)	Quantity of unit packages per exterior container	
6.00-16	1 Pair	8	3
6.50-16	1 Pair	8	3
7.00-16	1 Pair	4	2
7.00-20	1 Pair	4	3
7.50-15	1 Pair	6	2
7.50-16	1 Pair	6	2
7.50-17	1 Pair	6	2
7.50-20	1 Pair	4	4
8.20-15	1 Pair	4	3
8.25-16	1 Pair	4	2
8.25-20	1 Pair	4	4
9.00-15	1 Pair	4	4
9.00-16	1 Pair	4	4
9.00-20	1/2 Pair	3 (2 Pair)	2
10.00-15	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	2
10.00-20	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	2
10.00-22	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	2
10.00-24	1/2 Pair	6 (3 Pair)	4
10.50-18	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	2
11.00-18	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	2
11.00-19	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	2
11.00-20	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	2
11.00-24	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	2
12.00-20	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	2
12.00-24	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	3
13.00-24	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	3
14.00-20	1/2 Pair	4 (2 Pair)	3
14.00-24	None	(1 Pair)	1
16.00-20	None	(1 Pair)	3
16.00-24	None	(1 Pair)	3
16.00-25	None	(1 Pair)	3

TABLE IV. Type of boxes and net weight limitations.

Type	Net weight limitations	Dimensions
1	125 pounds	See figures 1 & 2
2	176 pounds	See figures 3 & 4
3	212 pounds	See figures 3 & 4
4	242.3 pounds	See figures 3 & 4

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TABLE V. Number of wires required for type 2, 3, and 4 box mats.

Type	Number of wires required
2	5
3	5
4	6

TABLE VI. Number of 1 3/8 inch x 14° staples required.

Type box	Into B	Into C
2	6	5
3	6	6
4	6	6

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Tire chain assemblies and spare cross chains covered by this specification are intended for use on military tactical wheeled vehicles equipped with military single pneumatic tires. Spare chains are used for repairing the tire chain assemblies.

6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Type, MS drawing number and part number, of required item (see 1.2 and 3.3).
c. If first article samples are not required (see 3.1).
d. If responsibility for inspection shall be other than as specified (see 4.1).
e. If responsibility for inspection equipment shall be other than as specified (see 4.1.1).
f. If inspection conditions shall be other than as specified (see 4.3).
g. If first article inspection is not required (see 4.4).
h. Quantity of cross chains per unit package (see 5.1.4.2).

6.3 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodian:
Army - AT

Preparing activity:
Army - AT

(Project No. 2540-A331)

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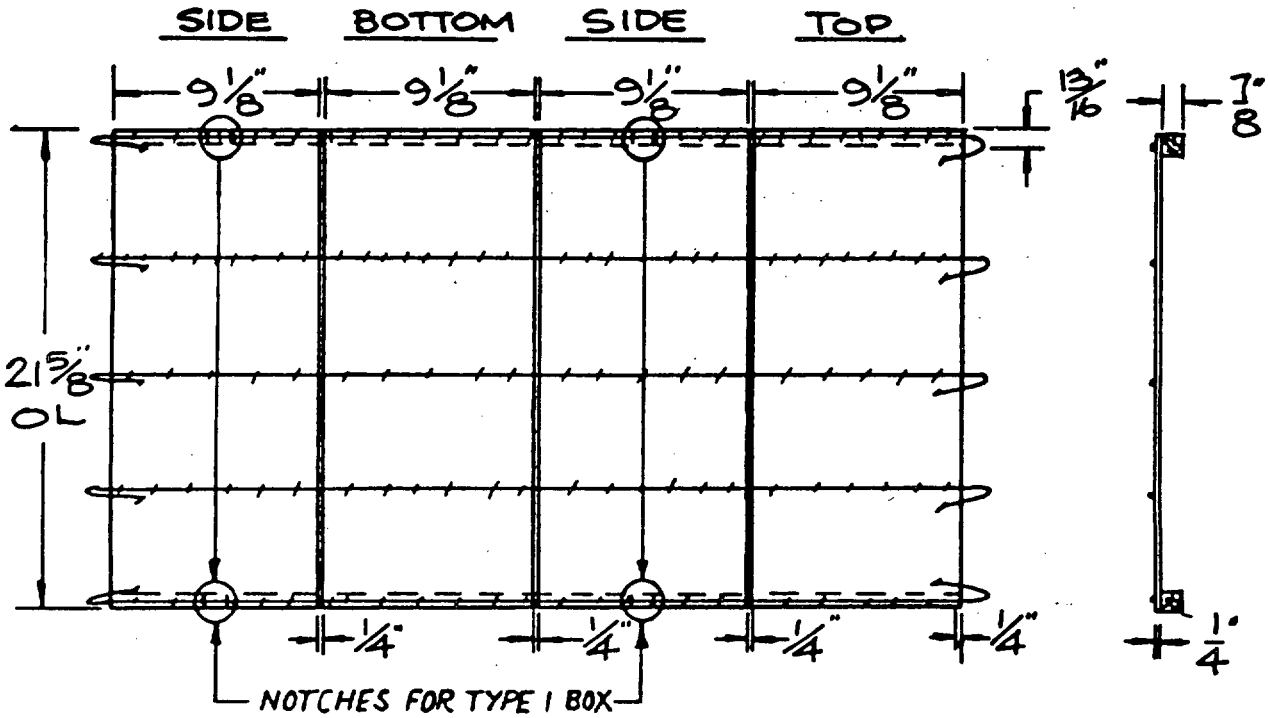


FIGURE 1. Type 1. - Box Mat Assembly.

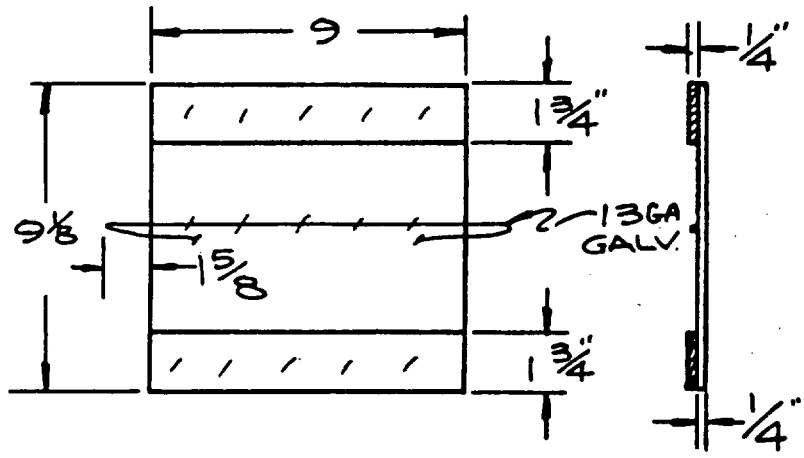
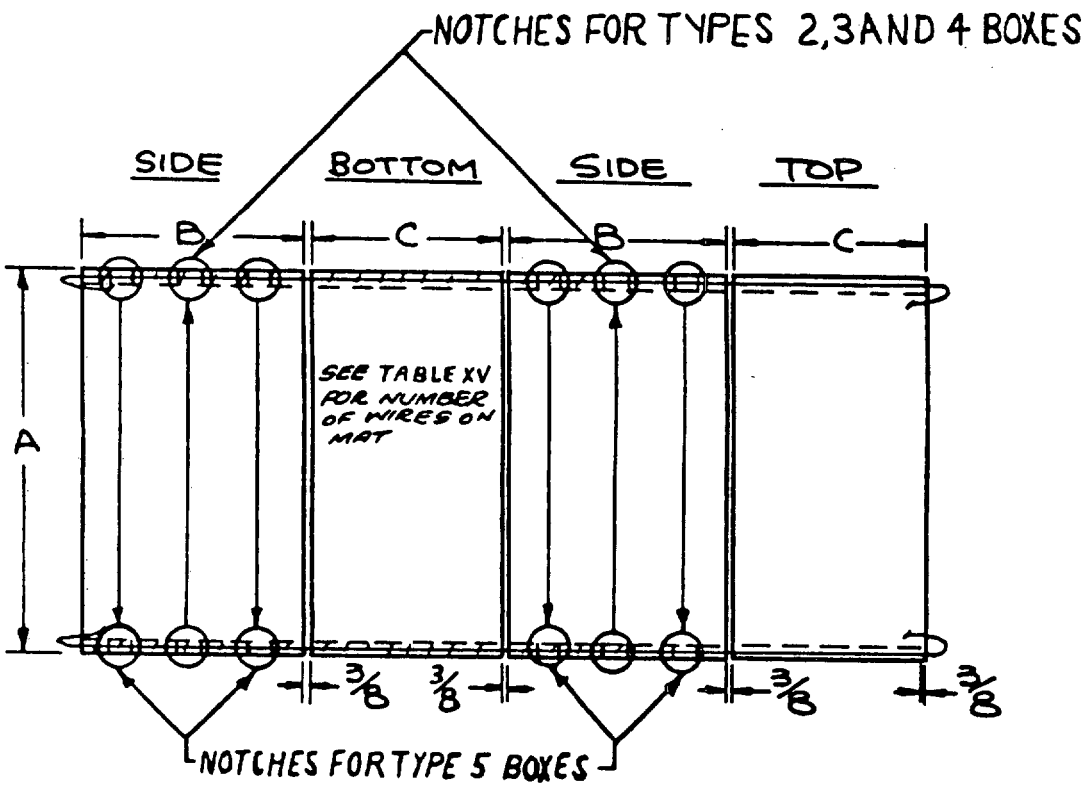


FIGURE 2. - Type 1. End Assembly

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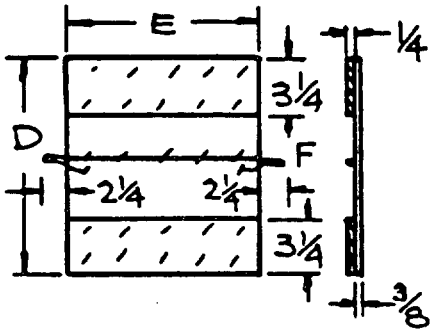


Box Type	DIMENSIONS IN INCHES		
	MAT. STOCK LENGTH	CLEAT LENGTH	
	A	B	C
2	22½	12	9⅛
3	22½	12¾	11
4	25	12¾	11
5	27½	14½	14½

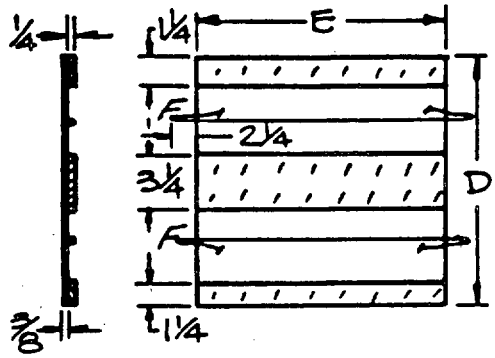
FIGURE 3.- Box mat assembly for type 2, 3, 4, and 5 boxes.

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End style for type 2, 3, and 4 boxes.



End style for type 5 box.



DIMENSIONS IN INCHES FOR BOX ENDS.

Box No.	INCHES D	INCHES E	F. GALV. WIRES
2	12	9	1-13 GAGE
3	12 3/4	10 7/8	1-13 GAGE
4	12 3/4	10 7/8	1-13 GAGE
5	14 1/2	14 3/8	2-13 GAGE

FIGURE 4.- End assemblies for type 2, 3, 4, and 5 boxes.

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